

DynoWeb Competitor Wound Map

Status: Canonical copy weapon. The ranked list of what every rival does badly — mined from their own 1–3★ reviews and real r/shopify threads — with the exact clause of DynoWeb copy that turns each wound against them. Use it to write ads, the App Store listing, outreach, and battle cards. Pairs with [dynoweb-vocabulary.md](#) (how we talk) and [dynoweb-icp.md](#) (who we talk to).

Built: 2026-07-17 · **Method:** live pull of App Store negative-filtered reviews (Microsoft Clarity, MIDA, Lucky Orange, OptiMonk) + r/shopify via browser. Every quote is verbatim from a real merchant with a store name. Nothing synthesized.

0 · The one structural fact that frames everything

The two apps closest to DynoWeb's **diagnosis** half are *loved*:

App	Rating	Reviews	Negative (1–3★)	What that tells us
MIDA	4.9	448	9	Paid diagnosis, adored — 431 of 448 are 5★
Microsoft Clarity	4.6	1,670	162	Free diagnosis leader; more reviews than the whole paid field
Lucky Orange	4.7	799	49	Wounded incumbent — billing scandals (see §3)
OptiMonk (popups)	4.7	415	17	The <i>action</i> category — different wounds (see §4)

The complaints are never "this doesn't work as a heatmap." They're about setup, support, billing, trust, speed, and — the big one — *"I can see the problem, now what?"* **Do not build a better heatmap. The category is well-served. The gaps are in the seams around the tools.**

1 · Microsoft Clarity — the free leader (4.6★, 162 negative reviews)

Clarity owns free mindshare (a top r/shopify post evangelizing it has 115 upvotes). You will **never** win on "free replays." But its negatives are a gift, and **not one is about features**:

Wound A — Support is a black hole (the loudest, most-repeated complaint): - *"no support available. I've repeatedly emailed microsoft... I get zero response."* — Yarn Atelier, UK - *"can't receive confirm email and install, and no customer service, It's garbage."* — AUTO-VOX, HK - *"Support email but nobody ever answers (you don't even get an acknowledgement)."* — WorthyDeal, UK

Wound B — Setup breaks and strands you: - *"the system would not let me log in or properly link my account... the email address linked to the Clarity project could not be retrieved."* — Tropical Glass, UK - *"very difficult for a shopkeeper/retailer to grasp."* (prior research)

Wound C — Usability / comprehension: - *"cookie popups block the entire view and there's no simple way to hide them."* — Nikben, Sweden - *"trying to export data and it simply will not export... nobody has gotten back to me. I love it in theory, but if I can't use it, it's useless."* — Pakks, Australia

Wound D — Their AI ("Brand Agents") is half-baked: - *"changed all products a month ago but it's still showing old products... Shouldn't there be a 'Regenerate' button?... nobody ever answers."* — WorthyDeal, UK

Wound E — Replays unreliable on real devices (from r/shopify): - blank white screens, missing product images, broken CSS, "Page is loading, 7 seconds", checkout recordings cut off. And "wpm@" sandbox/bot links that make recordings "basically useless because they're blank."

Why this is our opening: Microsoft runs Clarity as a free loss-leader to feed its ad business. **It structurally will not staff human support for it.** A Shopify-native tool where *a human answers* and *a non-technical owner can actually read* it beats free on the exact axis free can't fix.

2 · MIDA — the loved paid tool (4.9★, only 9 negative)

MIDA is the hardest competitor precisely because merchants *love* it. Learn from its praise, and target its two thin cracks.

What they LOVE (do not try to beat this; match it, then differentiate): - "amazing for seeing where people go, which page they leave off of." — Norient, US - "great for spotting where customers drop off or get stuck." — FORMA², Bulgaria - "I started selling the moment I made adjustments based on the behavior." — Punk Purple, US - "support is super responsive and helpful." — Peacock & Lime, Canada (support as a love, note)

Wound A — Bots pollute data (and, on a metered plan, the bill): - "my site is plagued by endless bot sessions." — Peacock & Lime, Canada

Wound B — Recordings silently fail: - "session recordings failing to be played / listed / accessible / shared" — 5 of 10 times. — Picasita, Spain (1 year using it)

Why this matters: MIDA proves the category buys "see where they drop off." We must **match that line for discovery** and win elsewhere — on *acting* on what the replay shows, not just showing it.

3 · Lucky Orange — the wounded incumbent (4.7★, 49 negative)

Its negatives are a **billing horror show**. This is the single richest lesson for our pricing — every wound here is a promise we can make.

Wound A — Billing betrayal (brutal, repeated, emotional): - "7 years of loyalty met with a 2,400% hike... a \$10 plan to a \$249 plan — without explicit consent." — PAPER BAGS, Cyprus - "we had been getting billed... the 'No active subscription' message was a bug, which their team later admitted." — IMB■DHI, US - "downgraded to the free plan... was still charged... I also needed to manually delete the app to fully stop charges, which wasn't clearly communicated." — Stella Wolfe, Canada - "Says free 100 sessions per month, then asks to subscribe to \$49 after the trial. Misleading." — KangaFeet, US

Wound B — Quota / storage gotchas: - "the €19 basic plan only supports 100–200 visitors... it stops recording and shows an error saying the storage is full... you have to pay €20–30 more... support says you can't free up disk space by deleting." — PetWoOw, UAE

Wound C — Slows the store: - "Downloaded this app and this SLOWED DOWN our entire store... they are not replying about a refund. This app took thousands of dollars from us!" — Health Ranger Store, US

Wound D — Accuracy: - "Very inaccurate and unreliable." — Home Haven Wellness, US

Wound E — Losing to free: - "We used Lucky Orange for about a year, then discovered Microsoft Clarity, which is completely free, and does everything we needed." — IMB■DHI, US

Why this matters: Lucky Orange is bleeding on trust and getting cannibalized by free. Its customers are *in motion* — prime switch-outreach targets. Lead with **"honest billing, no surprise charges, ever"** and you're speaking directly to their scar tissue.

4 · OptiMonk — the popup (action) category (4.7★, 17 negative)

This is DynoWeb's *actual paid category* (SmartNudge). Its wounds define the gap we build into.

Wound A — Surprise billing (same disease as the diagnosis tools): - *"we accidentally paid for a whole year... they refused to pay us back... the most money hungry I have ever experienced"* (\$800). — Sneakerzone, Denmark - *"25,000 page views means TOTAL page views... we flew past it... the most expensive pop-up app."* — Atlanta Luxury Bags, US

Wound B — Not Shopify-native (the integration seam): - *"not integrated with Shopify discounts, so you have to manually create discounts and upload them... the 'timer' on the exit intent popups is not actually valid... there is no connection to Shopify."* — Carver Junk Company, US

Wound C — Reliability that costs sales: - *"Optimonk deleted my one and only pop-up out of the blue due to an error on their side... significant headache and loss of sales."* — Butter & Crust, UK - *"this app doesn't work at all. As in will NOT show up on my site, even after signing up and paying."* — The Pond Shop, US - *"text kept disappearing when trying to create a pop-up design, infuriating."* — Lion & The Pear, UK

Wound D — Dumb timing (SmartNudge's entire reason to exist): - *"the pop-up appeared by the time customers were on it for a couple of seconds. Why give a discount to someone who just got on the page?"* — Bulletproof Pet Products, US

Why this matters: the popup category loses on billing, native plumbing, reliability, and *timing*. DynoWeb's SmartNudge (behavioral triggers, Shopify-native, auto-creates the discount) answers three of four *by design* — but only if we lead with "right-timed, native, honest billing," not "nudge."

5 · r/shopify — merchant voice (the act-gap, in their own words)

THE most important quote in this whole exercise — a Lucky Orange user:

"I like watching customers, but where is the value beyond that compared to Google Analytics?"

Its twin — a merchant who watched replays, spotted shoppers swiping his product image the wrong way, and hit a wall:

"I can't change it since it is built into my Shopify theme."

That is the act-gap, stated unprompted by real merchants. They can *watch* (free tools do it fine) but they're stranded at "now what?" — they can't tell what's wrong, or can't fix it. This is exactly the seam DynoWeb's "act, don't mirror" fills. Nothing validates the thesis better.

Other recurring r/shopify signals: - **Privacy fear of Microsoft:** *"Alternative to Microsoft Clarity that doesn't steal your data and doesn't hurt page speed?"* → a Shopify-native tool not feeding an ad giant is a real opening. - **Speed paranoia:** *"best heatmap that won't slow me down... I certainly won't be installing Hotjar."* Hotjar's reputation is bloat. Our <5KB async tracker (philosophy P7) is a genuine wedge. - **Tracking silently dies on theme update:**

"updated theme... clarity tracking, data is not there... gotta reinstall it every time?" (industry-wide; it's our own punarvasu blackout too.) - **Self/bot traffic pollution**: "blocked my ip... but my traffic keeps showing up and dilutes my data." - **Diagnosis pain is real**: "a product page looks fine until you see the conversion rate" (55 comments) — merchants can't spot what's hurting a listing they stare at daily. - **The pain, raw** (an India ethnic-fashion store, ~12k AOV — note: *anti-ICP*, but the emotion is the category's): 2,338 sessions → 0 orders in a week, "what am I doing wrong?", has heatmaps, can't translate them to sales.

6 · The cross-competitor wound map

Wound	Clarity	MIDA	Lucky Orange	OptiMonk	DynoWeb's counter
Billing betrayal	(free)	rare	brutal (2,400% hike, silent charges)	brutal (surprise annual, "total page views")	Transparent, session-based, bots never count , no surprise charge — philosophy P5
Support black hole	severe	<i>good</i>	mixed	mixed	A human answers — trivial at our size, impossible for a free loss-leader
Can't set up / grasp	severe	good	mixed	"can't preview it"	Plain-English, one next action — philosophy P6
Slows the store	some	—	yes	—	<5KB async, we publish the Lighthouse proof — P7
Not Shopify-native	—	—	reinstall-on-theme -change	manual discounts, dead timers	Native billing/theme/webhooks; auto-creates the discount
Dumb popup timing	n/a	n/a	n/a	yes ("just got on the page")	Behavioral triggers , not timers — SmartNudge's whole thesis
Data privacy	fed to ad giant	ok	ok	ok	Your data stays yours
"Value beyond watching?"	yes	yes	yes	(it acts)	We deploy the fix + show the dollars — philosophy P1

7 · The two strategic findings you can't unsee

1 · Billing-trust is the #1 killer of every paid competitor — not features, not accuracy. Lucky Orange (2,400% hike), OptiMonk (surprise \$800 annual) both bleed here; MIDA's calm is *why* it's loved. The reviews prove the highest-leverage promise in the category is: "**honest, transparent billing — no surprise charges, and bots don't burn your quota.**" Make it loud.

2 · Free (Clarity) is cannibalizing paid (Lucky Orange churns straight to it). The paid replay/heatmap category is *shrinking* under a free giant. **Charging for the mirror is swimming up that current.** The only durable position: **give the diagnosis away, charge for the act.** Anyone still selling heatmaps as the product is fighting the last war.

8 · The wedge, backed by a wound at every clause

"See the leak free. We fix it, not just show it — natively, right-timed, and we prove the dollars. **Honest billing, bots never count, and a human answers. Built for Shopify, not bolted on — and it won't slow your store.**"

Clause	The wound it targets
<i>See the leak free</i>	Clarity owns free — we don't fight it, we adopt it as the top of funnel
<i>We fix it, not just show it</i>	"value beyond just watching?" — every diagnosis tool's dead end
<i>natively... auto-creates the discount</i>	OptiMonk's "manual discounts, no Shopify connection"
<i>right-timed</i>	OptiMonk's "why discount someone who just arrived?"
<i>prove the dollars</i>	"where is the value?" — turn watching into money
<i>honest billing, bots never count</i>	Lucky Orange + OptiMonk billing rage; MIDA's bot pollution
<i>a human answers</i>	Clarity's "zero response" — the thing free can't fix
<i>won't slow your store</i>	"won't install Hotjar," Lucky Orange "slowed my whole store"

9 · Phrases — steal, and exorcise

USE (turn their wounds into our headlines): - "Stop watching them leave. Start fixing why." ← the act-gap - "Honest billing. No surprise charges. Ever." ← Lucky Orange / OptiMonk - "Bots don't burn your quota." ← MIDA / metered-plan pain - "A real human answers." ← Clarity's black hole - "Your data stays yours — not fed to an ad giant." ← Microsoft privacy fear - "Under 5KB. Won't touch your store speed — and we'll prove it." ← Hotjar/Lucky Orange bloat - "Popups that fire when they're actually leaving — not two seconds after they arrive." ← OptiMonk timing

EXORCISE (merchants' own hate-words — your copy should quietly banish these feelings): "infuriating" · "money hungry" · "took thousands of dollars" · "use at your own risk" · "garbage" · "too many bugs" · "misleading" · "very difficult to grasp" · "if I can't use it, it's useless".

10 · How to use this

- **Writing an ad, page, or the App Store listing?** Pick the wound your buyer feels most (billing? can't-act? speed?) and lead with the matching §9 line.
- **Doing switch-outreach?** Lucky Orange's billing-burned customers are in motion — target them with "honest billing + you keep your history."
- **Building a battle card / comparison table?** §6 is it. Never claim we out-feature MIDA — claim we *act* where it only shows.
- **Update by evidence, with date.** Re-pull negatives quarterly; competitors fix wounds and open new ones.

Sources

Live App Store negative-filtered reviews (Clarity, MIDA, Lucky Orange, OptiMonk) + r/shopify threads, pulled 2026-07-17. Every quote carries its store name and country above. Cross-refs: [dynoweb-icp.md](#), [dynoweb-vocabulary.md](#), [philosophy.md](#) (P1, P5, P6, P7).